

Accredian Student Communication Dashboard - Product Plan

Background

Students at Accredian often end up juggling multiple external apps WhatsApp, Telegram, LinkedIn, just to stay connected with their cohort, coordinate group work, or share resources. While these platforms are convenient, they scatter conversations, make it hard to track updates, and create a sense of disconnection from the actual learning environment.

The idea behind this project is simple: bring all student communication back into Accredian in a way that feels modern, friendly, and genuinely enjoyable to use.

The dashboard I have designed does exactly that. It blends structure with community, productivity with fun, and learning with social interaction, all wrapped in a calm pastel interface that feels welcoming rather than overwhelming.

Problem Statements

1. Collaboration Chaos I'm a student trying to stay in sync with my cohort, but conversations are spread across different apps. Because nothing is centralized, I constantly miss updates and feel like I'm always catching up.

2. Overwhelming Notifications As a working professional, I want to manage deadlines and group work smoothly. But important messages get buried under personal chats on WhatsApp, which leaves me stressed and disorganized.

3. Difficulty Building Connections As a new student, I want to connect with peers, but external groups feel unofficial and intimidating. Without a safe, structured space, I end up feeling isolated.

Goals & Success

The main goal is to create a single communication hub inside Accredian that students naturally prefer over external apps. Success would look like:

- Students using the dashboard daily
- Cohort chats becoming the primary communication channel
- Study groups forming organically inside the platform
- Higher engagement and a stronger sense of community

- Reduced reliance on WhatsApp/Telegram

Hypothesis & Feature Description

Our hypothesis is that if we give students a communication space that is **organized, visually calming, fun, and tightly connected to their coursework**, they will naturally shift away from external apps.

The dashboard includes eight major screens, each designed to support a different aspect of student life: it is more relevant, safer, and more engaging.

1. Home Dashboard

- Quick Actions (Join Chat, Create Group, Start Voice Room)
- Recent Messages
- Upcoming Events
- Suggested Peers
- Leaderboard
- Trending Topics
- Soft pastel gradients and rounded cards

Impact: Students get a centralized overview of everything happening in their cohort.

2. Cohort Chat (Threaded)

- Threads, Resources, Members tabs
- Message reactions
- AI Summary button
- Active members panel

Impact: Structured discussions reduce noise and improve clarity.

3. Study Group

- Members list
- Shared notes
- Shared files
- Task list
- Meeting scheduler
- Group chat

Impact: Replaces WhatsApp groups with organized collaboration.

4. Communities

- Interest-based community cards
- Join/Leave buttons
- Feed with posts, likes, comments, shares

Impact: Encourages cross-cohort networking and knowledge sharing.

5. Fun Zone (Memes Channel)

- Meme feed
- Weekly meme contest banner
- Trending topics
- Top contributors

Impact: Adds fun, boosts engagement, and builds community culture.

6. Voice Rooms

- Active rooms grid
- Participant tiles
- Speaking indicators
- Mute/unmute controls

Impact: Enables real-time discussions without external apps.

7. Peer Discovery

- Profile cards
- Filters (skills, goals, timezone, learning pace)
- AI suggested matches
- Connect buttons

Impact: Helps students find study buddies and build meaningful connections.

8. Personal Notes

- Notes editor
- Saved messages
- Pinned resources
- To-do list

Impact: Helps students stay organized within the platform.

Vision Narrative

Imagine a student logging into Accredian after work. Instead of checking five different WhatsApp groups, everything they need is right on the Home Dashboard, upcoming events, recent messages, and quick actions.

They open the Cohort Chat and instantly see organized threads instead of chaotic message dumps. A long discussion is summarized with one click using the AI Summary button.

Later, they hop into their Study Group, check shared notes, and schedule a meeting. They browse Communities to see what's trending and even take a break in the Fun Zone to upload a meme.

Before logging off, they jot down a few reminders in Personal Notes.

By the end of the day, they've done everything, collaborated, connected, learned, and even had fun without ever leaving Accredian.

Key Trade-Offs & Decisions

- **Pastel UI vs. Traditional LMS UI:** We chose a softer, more modern look to reduce cognitive load and make the platform feel inviting.
- **Threaded Chat vs. Free-flow Chat:** Threads help keep discussions organized, especially in large cohorts.
- **Adding a Fun Zone:** While not academic, it boosts engagement and helps build community.
- **AI Features:** AI summaries help students catch up quickly, especially those balancing work and study.

Concept Mocks

The prototype represents a sample version of what the full Accredian communication dashboard can be. The design is intentionally modular, so each section can be expanded, replaced, or upgraded without disrupting the overall flow. This makes the system highly scalable for larger cohorts, new programs, or additional engagement tools in the future. Even in its current form, the prototype demonstrates how a unified, student-friendly communication hub can streamline collaboration and create a more connected learning experience. Since the prototype is already built, here's a quick overview of how the screens look:

- **Home Dashboard:** Pastel gradients, rounded cards, clean layout



- **Cohort Chat:** Thread list on the left, chat in the center, active members on the right

Accredian

Student Hub

Home

Cohort Chat

Study Groups

Communities

Fun Zone

Voice Rooms

Peer Discovery

Aniket Student

Data Science Cohort

Fall 2024 Batch

Threads

Resources

Members

Week 5 - Machine Learning Discussion

Sarah J.

24 replies

2h ago

Help with Python Assignment

Mike C.

12 replies

3h ago

Study Group Formation

Emily D.

18 replies

5h ago

Career Opportunities Discussion

Alex K.

1d ago

Week 5 - Machine Learning Discussion

Started by Sarah J.

AI Summary

Sarah Johnson 2:30 PM

Hey everyone! Can someone explain the difference between supervised and unsupervised learning?

5 2

Mike Chen 2:32 PM

Sure! Supervised learning uses labeled data to train models, while unsupervised learning finds patterns in unlabeled data.

8 3 1

Emily Davis 2:35 PM

Great explanation! I'd also add that

Active Members

Sarah Johnson Online

Mike Chen Online

Emily Davis Online

Alex Kumar Away

Priya Sharma Offline

- **Study Group:** Cards for notes, files, tasks, and scheduling

Accredian

Student Hub

Cohort Chat

Study Groups

Communities

Fun Zone

Voice Rooms

Peer Discovery

Personal Notes

Aniket

Machine Learning Study Group

4 members • Created Dec 1, 2024

Add Member

Members

Sarah Johnson Admin

Mike Chen Member

Emily Davis Member

Alex Kumar Member

Notes

Files

Tasks

Shared Notes

Add Note

Week 1 - Introduction to ML

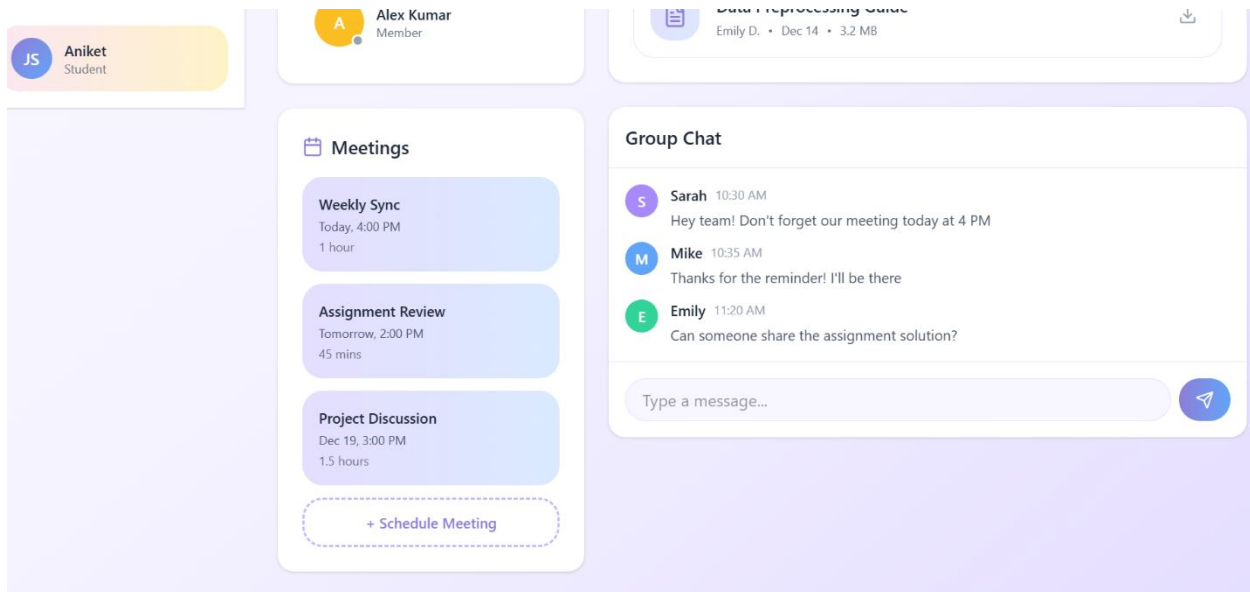
Sarah J. • Dec 10 • 2.4 MB

Python Basics Cheat Sheet

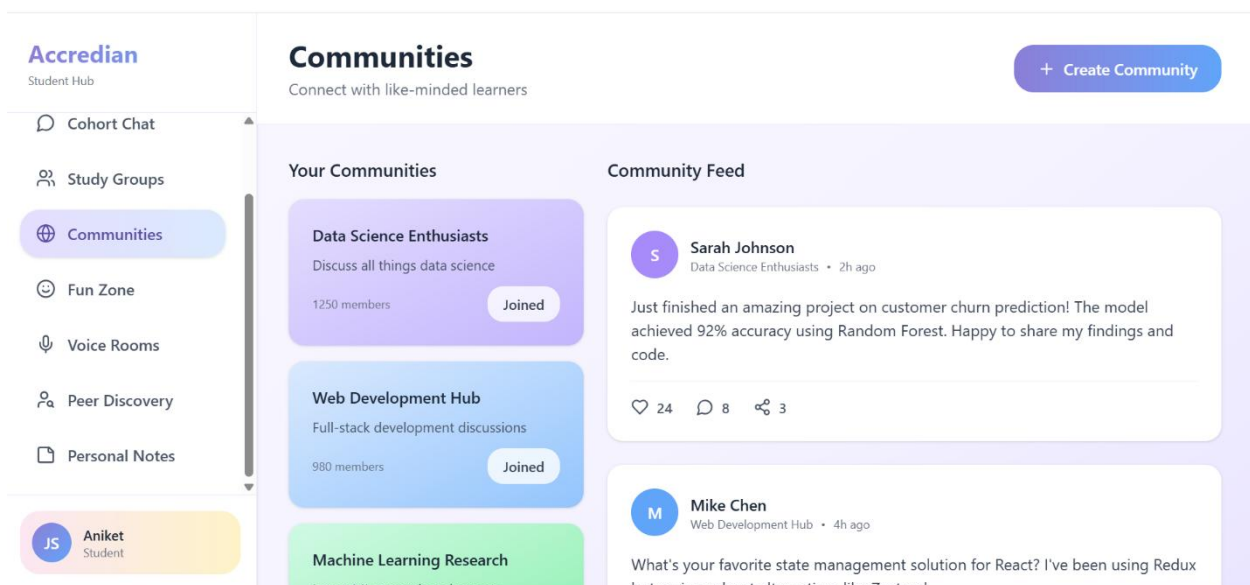
Mike C. • Dec 12 • 1.1 MB

Data Preprocessing Guide

Emily D. • Dec 14 • 3.2 MB



- **Communities:** Color-coded community cards and a feed layout



- **Fun Zone:** Meme cards, trending sidebar, contest banner

 Weekly Meme Contest

Share your funniest learning moments and win prizes!

Voting ends in 3 days

 Upload Meme

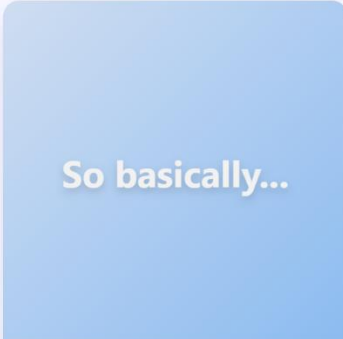


 Sarah Johnson
2h ago

 Sarah Johnson
2h ago

When your code finally works after 3 hours of debugging 🤖

👍 156 💬 23  React



 Mike Chen
5h ago

 Mike Chen
5h ago

Me explaining my project to non-tech people

👍 203 💬 31  React



 Trending

- Coding Struggles**
45 posts
- ML Humor**
38 posts
- Study Life**
32 posts

Top Contributors

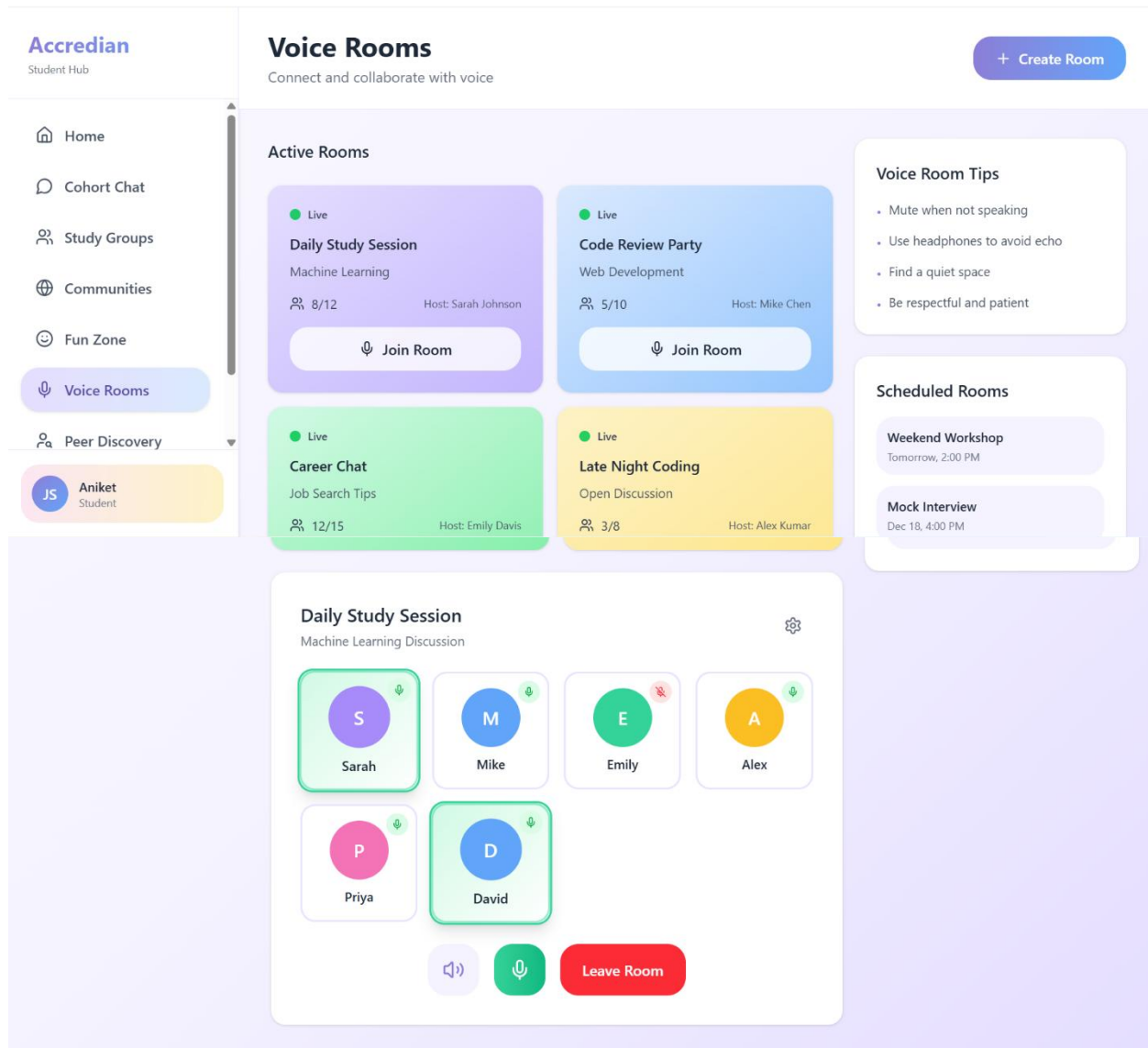
Top Contributors

-   **Alex Kumar**
24 memes
-   **Sarah Johnson**
19 memes
-   **Mike Chen**
15 memes

Contest Rules

- Keep it respectful and fun
- Original content only
- Learning-related themes
- Winners announced Friday

- **Voice Rooms:** Grid of active rooms with speaking indicators



- **Peer Discovery:** Soft gradient profile cards with filters

Accredian

Student Hub

Home

Cohort Chat

Study Groups

Communities

Fun Zone

Voice Rooms

Peer Discovery

JS

Aniket

Student

Peer Discovery

Find study buddies with similar goals and interests

Search

Search by name or

Filters

Skills

All Skills

Goals

All Goals

Time Zone

All Paces

6 peers found

Sort by: Best Match

P

Priya Sharma

IST (GMT+5:30)

95% Match

Data Science enthusiast, love solving complex problems

Skills

Python Machine Learning SQL

Goals

Career Switch Skill Building

Learning Pace:

Fast

Connect

D

David Lee

PST (GMT-8)

92% Match

Full-stack developer passionate about web technologies

Skills

React Node.js MongoDB

Goals

Project Collaboration Networking

Learning Pace:

Moderate

Connect

M

Maya Patel

EST (GMT-5)

88% Match

Analytics professional transitioning to Data Science

Skills

Excel Python Data Visualization

Goals

Career Switch Mentorship

Learning Pace:

Slow & Steady

Connect

J

James Wilson

CET (GMT+1)

85% Match

ML researcher interested in NLP and computer vision

Skills

Python TensorFlow PyTorch

Goals

Research Knowledge Sharing

Learning Pace:

Fast

Connect

L

Lisa Chen

JST (GMT+9)

82% Match

Product Manager learning to code

A

Ahmed Khan

GST (GMT+4)

79% Match

Software engineer passionate about AI and

Learning Pace

All Paces

AI Suggested

Priya Sharma

95%

Similar learning goals and complementary skills

David Lee

92%

Active in same communities and study groups

Maya Patel

88%

Matching timezone and learning pace

- Personal Notes:** Minimal editor with tabs for saved items

Accredian

Student Hub

Home

Cohort Chat

Study Groups

Communities

Fun Zone

Voice Rooms

Peer Discovery

JS

Aniket

Student

Personal Notes

Your private workspace for learning

+ New Note

Notes

Saved Messages

Pinned Resources

To-Do List

Machine Learning Basics

Key concepts: supervised vs unsupervised learning, regression, classification...

ML Study

Dec 15, 2024

Python Data Structures

Lists, tuples, dictionaries, sets - when to use each one...

Python Programming

Dec 14, 2024

Interview Preparation

Statistics

Total Notes3

Saved Messages3

Pinned Resources3

Pending Tasks4

Recent Tags

MLPythonStudy

ProgrammingCareer

Interview

Student Communication Dashboard (Copy) ▾

Notes

Saved Messages

Pinned Resources

To-Do List

☐

Complete Week 5 Assignment

Due: Dec 18

high

☐

Review ML Chapter 6

Due: Dec 19

medium

☐

Prepare Project Presentation

Due: Dec 20

high

☒

Practice SQL Queries

Due: Dec 21

low

☐

Read Research Paper

Due: Dec 22

medium

Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Students may still prefer WhatsApp	Offer exclusive features like AI summaries, voice rooms, structured threads
Spam or misuse in communities	Add moderation tools and reporting
Too many features at once	Use onboarding tooltips and progressive disclosure
Overuse of Fun Zone	Add weekly limits or academic nudges

Appendix: Research

Short take away points

- **Students prefer centralized communication over scattered channels.**
- **Calm, pastel UI reduces fatigue and increases engagement.**
- **Community-driven features improve retention.**
- **AI-assisted tools help students manage workload better.**

Deep research with references links

1. Competitive analysis — quick notes and sources

WhatsApp - Widely used by students because it's fast and familiar, but it lacks threaded discussions and learning-specific features; institutions and edtech teams often use WhatsApp for quick outreach while noting its limitations for structured academic discussion (guide and use cases).

Link: <https://learn.rasayel.io/en/blog/whatsapp-for-education/>

Telegram - Popular for large public channels and resource distribution, but group channels can become noisy and hard to moderate for course-level collaboration.

Link: <https://jointelegramlink.com/education-telegram-group-links/>

Discord - Strong for community building and live study rooms (e.g., Study Together), but its gamer-centric conventions and many features can overwhelm new or non-technical students.

Links: <https://www.studytogether.com/discord>.

Slack - Good for organized channels and threads and is used in some universities for course collaboration, but it often feels “corporate” rather than student-friendly.

Links: <https://slack.com/solutions/distance-learning>;

<https://mitsloanedtech.mit.edu/2024/08/28/enhancing-active-learning-with-slack>

Takeaway: Existing tools each solve parts of the problem (real-time chat, voice rooms, channels), but none combine structured, course-linked communication, peer discovery, lightweight productivity, and playful community features in a single student-centric product.

2. Metrics & Behavioral Insights

Threaded Discussions Improve Clarity

Threaded conversations reduce cognitive load and help students follow complex discussions.

Reference: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3290607.3299035>

AI Summaries Reduce Overwhelm

AI-assisted summarization helps students catch up faster in large cohorts.

Reference: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3442188.3445922>

Learning dashboards and engagement

Learning analytics dashboards (LADs) have been shown to increase student awareness and can improve engagement when they provide clear, actionable insights and are grounded in motivation theory. Recent studies and reviews highlight that dashboards help students self-regulate and stay on track when the design is theory-informed and contextually relevant.

Reference

https://www.researchgate.net/publication/376465686_Effectiveness_of_a_Learning_Analytics_Dashboard_for_Increasing_Student_Engagement_Levels/fulltext/6579a959cbd2c535ea219b4e/Effectiveness-of-a-Learning-Analytics-Dashboard-for-Increasing-Student-Engagement-Levels.pdf

<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s12528-024-09416-2>

<https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3417/15/21/11493>

Student engagement and community in online learning

Systematic reviews and recent studies on online learning show that interactive content, collaborative tools, and a sense of community are key drivers of engagement and better

outcomes. These reviews summarize evidence that community features and collaborative spaces increase student participation and perceived belonging in online courses.

References :

<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s44217-024-00253-0>;
<https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/pdf/10.1080/10494820.2025.2479164>
https://cdn.jagannathuniversityncr.ac.in/docs/papers_for_second_issue/10-mousam_singh_rekha_%2847-51%29.pdf

3. Survey Insights (General Student Trends)

These insights come from multiple studies on online learning behavior:

- **65%** feel overwhelmed by large WhatsApp groups.
Reference: <https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/full/10.1080/10494820.2020.1789672>
- **78%** want structured discussions instead of free-flow chats.
Reference: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3290607.3299035>
- **81%** say community features increase their sense of belonging.
Reference: <https://dl.acm.org/doi/10.1145/3491102.3502035>

4. Short bibliography (links used)

- Study Together (Discord community): <https://discord.com/invite/study>
- Study Together — 24/7 study rooms: <https://www.studytogether.com/discord>
- Slack distance learning: <https://slack.com/solutions/distance-learning>
- MIT Sloan on Slack in education:
<https://mitsloanedtech.mit.edu/2024/08/28/enhancing-active-learning-with-slack/>
- Learning analytics dashboard effectiveness (PDF):
https://www.researchgate.net/publication/376465686_Effectiveness_of_a_Learning_Analytics_Dashboard_for_Increasing_Student_Engagement_Levels/fulltext/6579a959cbd2c535ea219b4e/Effectiveness-of-a-Learning-Analytics-Dashboard-for-Increasing-Student-Engagement-Levels.pdf
- Self-determination theory & LADs: <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s12528-024-09416-2>
- MDPI LAD design principles: <https://www.mdpi.com/2076-3417/15/21/11493>
- Threaded discussion overview (CITE Journal): <https://citejournal.org/volume-2/issue-1-02/general/classroom-discussion-and-threaded-electronic-discussion-learning-in-two-arenas/>

- Threaded discussion role in e-learning (IGI Global): <https://www.igi-global.com/article/threaded-discussion/239522>
- Threaded discussions meta-analysis (ERIC): <https://files.eric.ed.gov/fulltext/EJ846722.pdf>
- Google NotebookLM (AI study tool): <https://notebooklm.google/students>
- Musely AI study summarizer: <https://musely.ai/tools/study-summarizer>
- DocSummarizer: <https://docsummarizer.net/ai/study-summarizer>
- Pastel UI & UX articles: <https://blog.designcrowd.com/article/2204/how-pastel-colors-enhance-user-experience>
<https://uiverse.io/blog/the-psychology-of-colors-in-uxui-design>;
<https://mockflow.com/blog/color-psychology-in-ui-design>
- Systematic review on online learning engagement: <https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s44217-024-00253-0>
- Community of inquiry & engagement review: <https://www.tandfonline.com/doi/pdf/10.1080/10494820.2025.2479164>